New Website Brief for Xenia | March 2026

Ross House Association

Current website: www.rosshouse.org.au

247-251 Flinders Lane

Melbourne 3000 VIC

Deadline: We would like to begin the project in July 2026 and have it up and running early 2027.

Content: Written content will be provided by us. We will be tweaking existing content as well as adding some new stuff. We have some images and clips we would like to keep, but most of the images will need to be new. We would like the option to easily edit and change content in the future ourselves, but the content will be uploaded by you to start with.

Branding: Currently working on updating logo, colour palette and fonts.

Ongoing support: Required

Approach:

The following documents outlines RHA's ideal website and CMS. However, as a small non profit organisation we recognise that custom elements may not be financially feasible. Our priority is therefore to achieve the best possible solution at a lower cost.

We ask that you please:

- **Recommend existing platforms and plugins that may meet our needs**
- **Minimise custom development**
- **Clearly let us know what features would require custom development**
- **Provide alternative solutions to our user needs that would use existing plugins or be achieved in a more simple, lower cost way.**
- **Prioritise accessibility in all decisions and recommendations.**

About us:

Ross House (RH) is a five-storey, heritage-listed community building on Flinders Lane. It is the only self-managed, community-owned not-for-profit building in Australia (possibly the southern hemisphere), and has been an important part of the social justice and environmental community in Melbourne since 1987.

RH acts as a community hub, housing over 30 non-profit tenant organisations working towards social and environmental justice. Ranging from small, minimally funded grassroots groups to larger advocacy organisations with greater funding, Ross House provides low rent and support and resources for non profit organisations.

Many of our tenants work in advocacy and support for marginalised communities, including those from CALD, First Nations, and migrant and refugee backgrounds, as well as people with intellectual or physical disabilities and those experiencing homelessness. We also have members working in environmental sustainability and animal welfare.

The building also has seven affordable meeting rooms available for hire, often used for workshops and classes.

Ross House Association (RHA) is the anchor organisation that manages the building. We are run by a management committee made up of representatives from our member and tenant organisations. Our mission is:
To work towards a socially just, environmentally sustainable and non-discriminatory society based on the community development principles of inclusion, consultation and collaboration, by supporting and enhancing the contribution of small community organisations towards their communities and the broader society.

Ross House is a place for community groups to grow, connect and evolve.
Community in Action

Summary of key elements:

- a public website
- a secure user portal
- a meeting room booking system
- a database of organisations and contacts
- automated invoicing and payment systems
- internal communications tools
- **WCAG 2.2 Level AA accessibility standards**

Main Goals and objectives

- Get our name out there and show the world who we are as a community hub. We currently come across as just a meeting room service, but we are so much more!
- Better highlight our members and tenants and the amazing work they do.
- Act as a directory of social services available in the building to public seeking services.
- Increase interest in joining our membership and tenancy base
- Sell ourselves - Fundraise and increase donors
- Have a more simplified and accessible user experience
- Provide a digital membership and resource hub
- Consolidate our data and automate our behind the scenes tasks. too much of our labour is spent on manually processing ie. Invoices, refunds, email campaigns.
- Reduce our reliance on external platforms like: ie we use Jotform, Campaign monitor, Adobe e-sign, Outlook, Excel.
- Improve participation amongst members and tenants and improve transparency in information and governance.

Our Target Audience

RH Members and Tenants

We have a broad membership and tenancy base of not-for-profit organisations working for social justice and environmental sustainability. They are either 'tenants' who rent an office space in the building or 'members' who pay yearly to be a part of our network.

Our tenants and members include:

- Intellectual and physical disability advocacy, support, and services. Including Deaf, blind, acquired brain injury, and parents with disability.
- Psychosocial disability and mental health support
- Self-advocacy and peer-led orgs
- Disability led arts and media
- Aged care and elder rights advocacy and housing support
- Refugee and migrant, multicultural, and CALD support and services
- English language and cultural language education groups
- First Nations justice and self-determination organisations
- Training and support services for nonprofit organisations
- Community theatre, media, arts and crafts
- Climate and health organisations, and forest and environmental protection alliances
- Animal rights and ethical food system advocates
- Gender equity and women's advocacy organisations
- International development agencies

View our current members and tenants here > https://rosshouse.org.au/community-centre/

How Members and Tenants will use the website:

- **Book and Manage meeting rooms:** including cancelling, changing, and accessing unique meeting room access codes.
- **Learn about the RH community**: Including other members and tenants (supporting referrals and collaboration), learn about RH history, RHA staff and current RHA committee members.
- **Connect with other members and tenants:** promote events, share happy news, donate office furniture.
- **Manage tenancy and financial Info:** view leases and rental details (tenants only), access and pay invoices, view photo copier code, update billing information.
- **Stay up to date on building and community news**: find out about building works and access changes, RHA events, read the weekly e-bulletin, bimonthly community newsletter and other ad-hoc publications. Stay informed about available office spaces.
- **Communicate with RHA and report issues:** report maintenance, submit incident reports, provide feedback, and RSVP to events. Submit articles and info for the weekly e-bulletin, bimonthly newsletter and annual report. Submit requests to book a spot in the main window display.

- **Update Organisational details:** update private membership details such as staff contacts, nominated representatives. Update public info such as directory profile.
- **Keys and Swipes**: Update key registers (a list of authorised staff or volunteers with building access) and order new keys/sipes. See who is registered to what swipes.
- **RHA Equipment Grant**: Apply for and manage application for the biyearly RHA grant (tenants only).
- **Access Resources**: House rules, emergency procedures (tenants only), relevant policies, AV guides.
- **Participate in Governance:** Read minutes. View committee Members, AGM documents. Learn about any current subcommittees and working parties.
- **Engage with RHA fundraising efforts:** learn about current fundraising priorities, see how funds are being used, and share partnership or donor opportunities within their network

Future Members and Tenants

- **Learn about RH and our community members**: understand our mission, values, our story, and who is in our community of organisations.
- **Find out about membership and or tenancy:** benefits, eligibility, expectations, pricing, steps, view current office vacancies.
- **Understand the building and the facilities:** location, access, history and heritage, amenities, meeting rooms.
- **Learn about our community owned governance model:** How we are run, how the committee operates, how members are involved, participation expectations of becoming a member.
- **Read Public RHA publications**: Sign up to e-bulletin, access bimonthly Newsletter and Annual Report, and other ad-hoc publications.
- **Contact us:** get in touch/submit interest/arrange a visit.
- **Support Ross House:** learn about our f
- Fundraising, see how funds are being used, and donate.

Meeting Room Users (External, not members)

- **Learn about RH and our community members**: understand our mission, values, our story, and who is in our community of organisations.
- **Learn about our meeting rooms**: size, layout, capacity, accessibility, AV equipment, pricing, availability.
- **Book and pay for meeting rooms:** create an account, make bookings, see availability, access tax invoices/receipts and confirmations, booking reminders.
- **Opt in to receive booking confirmations by text or email**
- **Register for an AV induction**: On checkout and we will contact to book a time.
- **Manage Account**: Update details, contact, billing etc.
- **Access unique meeting room access codes.** View their codes for each booking. Understand how to access the building.

- **Access meeting room resources:** House rules, relevant policies ie cancellation and cleaning fee, AV user guides.
- **Manage bookings:** cancel, change, view.
- **Read Public RHA publications**: Sign up to e-bulletin, access bimonthly Newsletter and Annual Report, and other ad-hoc publications.
- **Support Ross House:** learn about our fundraising, see how funds are being used, and donate.
- **Enquire about spaces:** Before they have a user account they can enquire about the spaces, but not book them until they can log in.

Potential Partners and Donors

- **Learn about RH and our community members:** understand our mission, values, our story, and who is in our community of organisations.
- **Explore partnership and funding opportunities:** find out how to partner, donate, or support the Ross House community.
- **Read Public RHA publications:** Sign up to e-bulletin, access bimonthly Newsletter and Annual Report, and other ad-hoc publications.
- **Learn about Ross House fundraising and impact:** understand current fundraising priorities, see how funds are being used, and explore ways to support the community.
- **Contact RHA.**

Current Partners and Donors

- **Stay up to date about what's going on:** read newsletter, e-bulletin, updates on projects and funding outcomes.
- **Access donor and partner resources**
- **Manage donations or payment plans:** access invoices, update info.
- **Learn about further partnership or funding opportunities.**
- **Contact RHA.**
- **Receive and RSVP to RHA event invitations.**

Public looking for services

- **Find services:** view directory to connect with the right organisation or service for client needs, filter and search.
- **View member and tenant information:** public information, address, opening hours, services offered, contact details.
- **Read Public RHA publications**: Sign up to e-bulletin, access bimonthly Newsletter and Annual Report, and other ad-hoc publications.
- **Learn about RH and our community members:** understand our mission, values, our story, and who is in our community of organisations.

How we want to use the CMS and Website

Meeting Room Booking Management

- **Collect and manage meeting room bookings.**
- **Understand how people heard about us** and why they are booking with us.
- **Update Meeting Room Product Details:** Update photos, capacities, and other general info.
- **View availability of meeting rooms:** View daily availability, view weekly/monthly/yearly availability. For example, we may have to be able to work out what day/time is available for a weekly recurring booking.
- **Book and manage recurring meetings for users:** Some users will require recurring bookings throughout the year. E.g. The 3rd Wednesday of every month. We need to be able to book these in and invoice monthly. Recurring bookings must be made by us and not the user.
- **Manage and update product parameters.** (see Technicalities Section
- **Book and manage casual car park space bookings.** (see Technicalities)
- **Find and manage info about our members and tenants:** ie what their public phone number is, when they are open, what their access code it, manage their photocopier code.
- **Manage user account:** Approve user requests, edit/add info, create user accounts.

Facilities Management

- **Receive and manage maintenance requests.** Input our own requests and see/prioritise list.
- **Check the key database:** verify tenant or member access for borrowing keys.
- **View daily access codes and manage users' keys and swipes information.**
- **Sign in Contractors**: We currently use a folder is there a better way?
- **Book casual car park spaces for trades.**
- **Control permissions and user roles:** differentiate access for staff, tenants, members, and external users.
- **Pull analytics and reporting:** track website usage, bookings, publication downloads, and engagement metrics.
- **People to call database**
- **Alert tenants that they have received a parcel etc at front desk.**

Membership and Tenancy (M&T)

- **Upload signed tenant leases** to individual user info.
- **Upload signed membership renewal documentation:** Can membership renewal happen via the website. We currently do this type of thing through JotForm and Adobe.
- **Collect and manage M&T data:** including private contact details, organisational information, and key registers, financial info, constitutions.

- **View and edit public M&T information:** Update directory info.
- **View and manage tenancy and membership applications:** including expressions of interest and enquiries.
- **Track membership and tenancy analytics**: monitor enquiries, page visits, tenancy waitlists.
- **Receive and manage feedback:** from tenants, members, meeting room users.
- **Collect and manage grant applications:** RHA in-house grant for tenants.
- **Pull governance and org information**: How many tenants, members etc, type of user i.e. small nonprofit, associate tenant etc (see Technicalities Section), primary contacts, nominated representatives.

Communications and Publications

- **Keep everyone informed**: Publish news, updates, and communications to members, tenants, partners, and the public.
- **Upload and manage publications depending on user type:** Newsletters, annual reports, e-bulletin, and other ad-hoc publications are sometimes only for tenants, sometimes for external meeting room users etc.
- **Collect content submissions**: for newsletters, e-bulletins, and annual reports from members and tenants. Track community contributions.
- **Collect RSVPs for events**: including workshops, community events, AGM, or subcommittee meetings.
- **Remotely update digital screen in foyer:** display events, news, or room booking information.
- **Manage website content for public facing pages**: update directory listings, event information, and membership/tenancy information, blog, linked to socials.
- **Manage governance information**: Update Committee info, upload AGM documents and minutes.
- **Update Staff info and Bio's.**

Fundraising and Donor Management

- **Keep donors and partners informed about impact:** share fundraising updates, project progress. Communicate with donors and partners.
- **Manage fundraising content**: update public fundraising pages, highlight stories, and manage donation forms.
- **Maintain donor and partner database**: track contacts, contributions, and engagement history.

Financial Management

- **Send invoices and collect payments:** for room hire, memberships, tenancy, and other fees.
- **Manage donations.**
- **Refund cancelled bookings:** In line with our cancellation policy
- **View analytics and trends.**
- **Update product prices.**

Website examples with elements we like:

Our Community House - as a meeting room and hot desk booking site:

https://ochouse.com.au/

+ Lots of images

+ Clear idea of values

+ Clear buttons for starting the process

+ clear diagrams for the types of spaces on offer

+ Short sharp and shiny and easy access to the basics about who they are and what they offer.

+ Clear detailed information about spaces and the option to enquire about a space if you are not already a user.

Price Centre – as an example of community hub:

https://pridecentre.org.au/

+ Colourful and soft. Clear and professional without being corporate.

+ Clearly shows what their values are, and what's going on in the building.

+ Clear 'make a donation' and 'book a space' buttons when you scroll down and in top menu.

+ Easy to donate

+ Clear Donar and partnership information

+ Like the overall search function but don't know how this would work for us?

+ Really great resource directory

+ a page which outlines accessibility info

+ clear support us section in secondary menu

+ clear meeting room and pricing info

International Women's Development Agency - as a fundraising platform

https://iwda.org.au/

+clear vision, who they are and what they do

+ clear 'take action' and donate options

+ featured resource

+ great resources directory

+ clear donor and fundraising options

+ lots of images and 'faces'.

Oz harvest – for navigation

https://www.ozharvest.org/

+ simple and clear navigation

+ clear and informative

+ very user friendly

1. Meeting Room Booking System

Details:

- We need a new one – custom system we use now does not meet our needs.
- New users can register for an account but must be confirmed by us to book a room.
- Must work for a variety of user types, product/room types and pricing categories.
- Different users have different parameters. Not all users can view and book all products.
- Bookings are categorised as recurring and non-recurring. Recurring bookings are repeating weekly, fortnightly or monthly bookings.
- Products need to be easily editable by us.
- Users must accept terms and conditions before booking a room.
- If using AV equipment users must book a time to do an AV induction prior to their first meeting in that room. This needs to be clear.
- Users need a daily access code to access their meeting room.
- Need to be able to pull reports and see future availability and bookings, and booking analytics.
- Products can be booked in half hour blocks.
- Bookings for the following year do not open to the public until Dec 1.
- Confirmation emails and text messages need to be sent and include access codes.
    - Reminder emails and texts
- Victorian holidays and public holidays marked on the booking calendar.

Recurring and Non-Recurring bookings.

- Products are bookable as one offs or recurring.
- Recurring meeting bookings must be booked through us to ensure we can fit all required member and tenant bookings.
    - We need to be able to book a year of bookings easily but have this separated into monthly invoices.
- Nonrecurring meeting room bookings need to be booked by the user via their online account.

Classifications

Users have **two classifications**:

1. **User Type** (their relationship to Ross House)
2. **Pricing Category** (which determines booking costs)

These categories are separate but related.

Users by main type

- Members (Non Tenant)
- Members (Tenants)

- Commercial Tenant - New
- Facility Users (Non-member meeting room users)
- Donors/Partners
- Admin (us)
- Trades (us) – New

Users By Pricing Category

- Tenants
- Members
- Associate Members
- Facility Users (Non-member meeting room users)
    - Non Profit Small
    - Non Profit Large
    - For Profit Small or Individual
    - For Profit Large or Government or Education Organisation
- Admin/trades

Our Current products and parameters are:

Meeting Rooms

Meeting Rooms are viewable and bookable by all users. View all meeting rooms here>
https://rosshouse.org.au/facilities/meeting-room-hire-melbourne/

- Members and tenants can book 7am – 11pm, Monday - Sunday
- Facility users can only book 8am – 8pm, Monday – Sunday. Later bookings available on a case-to-case basis.
- Bookable in half hour blocks.

Hayden Raysmith 4.1 Room

- Minimum 2-hour booking.

Jenny Florence 3.1 Room

- Minimum 1 hour booking

Sue Healy 2.2 Room

- Minimum 1 hour booking

Rainbow Room

- Minimum 1 hour booking

Esther Harris Room

- Minimum 1 hour booking

Christine McAuslan

- Minimum 1 hour booking

Phone Booth

The phone booth is free and only bookable by our tenant organisations

- Only bookable a week in advance
- Online bookable for max 2 hours at a time
- Bookable in 30min blocks.

Casual Car Parks Bay 1 and 3

There are 2 casual car parks available for booking on a casual basis.

- Bookings must come through us to help manage use by trades.
- Bookable in half hour blocks with minimum half hour
- Price maxes out at 4 hours
- Commercial Tenant Melbourne Winery are the only exception. They need to be able to book the car park bays through their user account.

2. Xero and PayPal Integration

We currently use Xero and PayPal for our e-commerce and financial management. Unfortunately, a lot of the work is still done manually.

- Can we have a checkout directly on the website- who hosts this?
- We need 2 different payment options. Members and tenants pay via a monthly invoice, whereas most facility users pay for meeting room bookings via PayPal on booking.
- Costs need to be automatically updated/ additional charges requested to be paid or added to invoice when users make changes to their bookings.
- Some facility users with recurring bookings pay via a monthly invoice.
- Invoicing: We need to be able to send users one invoice with all monthly costs **through Xero**
    - Send charges to Xero at end of each month for invoicing
    - No separate little invoices but a combined statement of all costs due per organisation
    - Rent and internet charges are charged in advance
    - Room Bookings and Carparks are charged retroactively
    - Other invoiceable items include purchase office stationary and paper, printing and photocopying charges, storage shelf costs.
- Currently we need to manually send refunds. We need automatic refunds for cancellations booked via PayPal that adhere to our cancellation policy:
    - *At least 2 business days, from the date of the booking, is required for cancellation of room bookings, otherwise 50% of the hire price will be charged. If no notification is given before the date of the meeting, the full price will be charged regardless of whether the room was used or not.*
    - *Cancellations, outside of 2 business days, can be made by you, via your online user account.*
      For cancellations less than 2 business days, you will need to contact Ross House directly via email to advise of the cancellation.
    - ***PayPal Booking Fee:*** *Bookings paid for via PayPal include a non-refundable 2% booking fee. Cancellation refunds are calculated after deducting this fee.*

- Rent: is based on the size of an organisation and space. Our current scale for example is:
    - Incubator - negotiated rate
    - Small - $360 /yr/m2 (plus GST)
    - Medium - $395 /yr/m2 (plus GST)
    - Large $420 /yr/m2 (plus GST)
    - Associate $530 /yr/m2 (plus GST)
- Products: Our currently pricing structure for producst is here > https://rosshouse.org.au/facilities/pricing/
    - Our meeting rooms are priced according to organisation type and size. For example, a small nonprofit pays a different rate to a large for profit group.
    - Our rooms are also priced according to their size, capacity and AV capability. We currently use a category system A+, A, B, C.

3. User Portals

All users need some kind of portal or user account they sign in to. However different types of users are limited to what they can access, based on how they use the site. See Target Audience section for details about how portals need to be used.

- All members and users need to have one user account per organisation only – regardless of how many different people from that organisation use the portal. One member = one organisation. Not one individual.

4. Email Campaigns

We currently send email campaigns though Campaign Monitor including a weekly e-bulletin and building notifications. We would like these to be sent via our CMS to email or to view in user accounts and stop using Campaign Monitor.

5. Databases

We need to be able to store back end info for users and fundraising databases etc. We currently save everything to files on share point and use mostly excel for databases. Our current CMS has some areas to fill in information, but it has never worked the way we need to so it doesn't get used properly.

- Information we need to be able to store includes but is not limited to:
    - Contacts – primary, secondary, admin.
    - Billing details
    - Nominated Representatives
    - Lease information and general tenancy info
    - Security info – codes, keys, swipe info, photocopier codes
    - Relationship management for donors and partners
    - Public info, services offered, opening hours, volunteer opportunities.

6. Accessibility

A new website provides an opportunity to create an accessible website that caters for our disability community:

- Deafblind and blind
- Intellectually disabled
- Neurodivergent

The new website must consider WCAG 2.2 Level AA accessibility standards**.**
Key considerations include:

- compatibility with screen readers **such as JAWS**
- keyboard navigation
- accessible forms and booking processes
- avoiding inaccessible CAPTCHA systems
- clear navigation and plain language
- support for Easy English resources
- captioning for video where used

7. Location

A location map on the contact page and wherever else suitable. The location of our building is a real selling point for people. Not on every page like it is now.

8. Directory and Bookings TV Screen

- We have a TV that will be connected to the Wi-Fi and we want to be able to show what meetings are happening in what room on the day.
- We are also getting a digital screen that will show a directory of who is in the building – a list of our tenants and meeting rooms.
- We need to be able to update these remotely and easily from the back end.

9. Security System Integration

We use a security system called Inner Range Integrite:

- Keypads and swipe on main doors
- Keypads on meeting room doors
- Key pads on some offices

- Users have access to our building from around 7 am to 11pm, but the doors are only open from 10am – 4pm when the reception is staffed. Some doors remain locked at all times and are only accessible via a code or swpie. Some people have a 'permanent code' a code they can use any time any day to open what they require. Other people have a daily code linked to a meeting room booking they must use.

- Users need to be able to securely look up their codes, whether permanent or daily
- How can this system be better integrated with our website.

10. TagVenue

We receive a large volume of enquiries through a platform called TagVenue. https://www.tagvenue.com/au/. The platform provides a chat forum for us to communicate with clients, before setting them up a user account on our website and booking as per usual.

We need a way of recording which users found us through this platform, as well as being able to pull data regarding trends, and income from this platform.